

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1999-06-30

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,
2 the procedures related to the translation of bahá'í writings into english,
3 whether involving whole works or extracts. we have been asked to share
4 with you the following conclusions, which may relate to your publishing programs or
to those of other b ahá'í publishers within your jurisdiction.

5 As in the past, certain Tablets or extracts translated into english for use or
6 publication by the bahá'í world center or other publishers will continue to
7 be reviewed and approved in the holy land and designated as "authorized
translations."

8 however, because of the increasing need for translation of specific mate-
9 rial, particularly in relation to growing scholarly interest in the faith and
10 its various Teachings, favorable consideration has been given to allowing wider use
of provisional translations. individual believers, of course, remain

11 free to translate into english any of the holy writings for their own use.

12 Such translations may also be published in circulars and journals without review
other than by the editors of such publications. They may also be

13 shared electronically. in all such cases they should be clearly identified as

"provisional translations."

The house of justice has now established a mechanism which will allow

14 for inclusion in books and pamphlets of provisional translations which are of
sufficiently good quality for wide distribution. Arrangements have been

15 made for such translations to be checked at the world center. when these

16 items are to be included in works intended for publication by a bahá'í pub-

17 lisher, the trust or publisher involved should forward them here for the nec-

18 essary clearance. in the case of items to be included in works submitted to

19 non-b ahá'í publishers, the authors or translators themselves should forward

20 the items here for consideration prior to the involvement of any non-b ahá'í 304.1

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306 679publishers. publications containing such translations, once these have been
307 cleared, should indicate that they are provisional translations.

The translations submitted for checking at the world center should

308 include copies of the Arabic or persian texts used by the translator(s). The
309 items sent will be considered both from the point of view of the quality of
310 the english rendering of the material and as to whether there are any major
311 doubtful points with regard to the accuracy of the translation itself. Those which fall
short on either of these counts will be returned to the sender with an explanation. for
instance, the translations may need further refining or
312 may contain mistakes of meaning, and, therefore, necessitate improvement
313 before resubmission.

it remains the prerogative of the world center to decide on the time-

314 liness and wisdom of publishing english translations of specific Tablets.
315 Some may be identified as not suitable for publication at the present time.
316 The house of justice is hopeful that this new arrangement will lead to
317 the availability of a greater amount of translated material and avoid the
318 present delays in approving fully authorized translations.
319 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

Department of tHe secretariat

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Policies on Translation and Publication of Bahá'í

Documents into English

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]